

900 GB SSD drive!?

Texas Memory System's RamSan-70 packs 900GB of high-speed SLC NAND flash onto a single PCIe card

iPhone as a touchscreen mouse?

Wow-Keys iPhone keyboard lets you input text from your iPhone or let it use apps on it to control your PC. Read more <http://on.mash.to/lm054h>

Slow PC performance, confusion over display cables...

Digit answers these issues and more...

Slow PC performance

Here is my PC configuration
 Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo
 Motherboard: D865GSA
 RAM: 2 GB(two 1GB RAM in each slots)
 HDD: 160GB
 I have purchased my PC parts in Jan-2007. It was assembled (with 512MB memory) by a friend. It was running good for the first two years and then it started to slow down. After that my PC performance just started to degrade. It takes a long time to boot and shut down. Whenever I try to open a new window, it takes ages. Please help me diagnose this problem. I am also planning to install Ubuntu in my PC after improving my system performance.

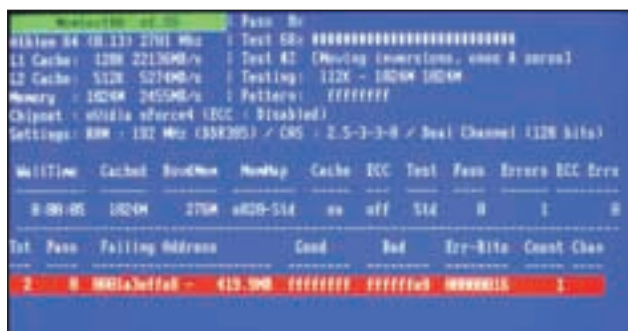
Duraimurugan Tharmaraj

Running a system for 2 years means that your computer might have gathered a lot of junk. Most software leave something behind even after uninstalling.

Defrag your hard drive. This tool can easily be accessed by right-clicking on a drive, clicking on properties, and then using the defragmentation tool under the tools tab.

It could take quite a long time.

Again reinstalling windows from scratch could help immensely, but will require a lot of work. You will need to back up all your data to a safe location, format your drive, reinstall windows, and then restore your data and applications over time.



Try using Ubuntu with your system. It generally performs better than Windows anyway, and you may immediately see some improvement. If it too runs slowly.. then there might be a hardware problem. Since RAM is the latest addition, it is likely to be the culprit. Sometimes mixing RAM modules of different speeds causes issues.

Run a test on your RAM. Windows includes a tool that is accessible through your boot menu. Press F8 while booting, and then when the menu appears, press tab to go to the memory test. You can also use Memtest86 (<http://www.memtest.org>)

DVI or VGA cable?

I'm using NVIDIA GTX 460 card and my monitor is Dell ST2220m which has a DVI and VGA input. Right now I'm using VGA input on the monitor through DVI port on graphic card (using DVI to VGA converter dongle). Should I buy new DVI cable for monitor. Will it increase any visual quality. I want to work on animation and vfx.

Kiran

Your graphic card outputs digital signals and if you use a DVI-to-DVI cable, there is no conversion to analog mode and thus hardly any loss from source to the monitor. If you use a DVI-to-VGA adapter, the digital signal from the graphics card

will first be converted to analog signal as VGA cable uses analog signals. In the conversion there may be a slight loss in the signal quality, but the difference is not noticeable unless you are using the highest resolution on your monitor. If you



want the best image quality, it is advisable to shift to a DVI-to-DVI cable, as ghosting is prominent at higher resolutions with a VGA cable.

From the Thinkdigit forum:

Installing Backtrack

I tried installing the Backtrack that i got from one of my Digit DVD and I reached up to partition manger. I have already installed Windows 7 in my system. I have drive D:\ (from Windows) which has 150 GB and I used only 33 MB in it. When Linux detected the hard disk and i choose the manual partition and selected this drive and allocated 100 GB to install Linux. In the Linux partition manager it shows 'unused'. When I click forward button it gives me an error "No root file system is defined. Please correct this from partitioning menu." Kindly help me on this.

Sivakumar

You have to select the mount point for the partition. Look around, you'll find the option for selecting the mount point and choose /. The / symbol stands for root file-system. Also choose a file system like ext4 and then continue. My advice will also be to have another partition with the mount point /home

In case you are having issues with the partitioner setup check out these pages: <http://bit.ly/iCLnxG> and <http://bit.ly/k9rqM3>.